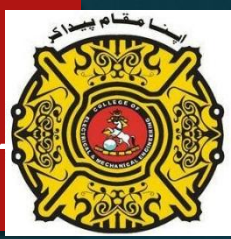




Professional Ethics



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LECTURE – 4



Course Information



Course Name	Professional Ethics
Course Code	HU-222
Credit Hours	2
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Visiting Hours	2-4 pm



Ethics from Islamic Perspective



- Ethics in Islam is nothing, but the body of injunction laid down in the Quran for the practical conduct of life and fully exemplified in the practice of the Holy Prophet throughout his life



Code of Ethics of the Prophet (PBUH)



- ▶ The Quran addresses the Prophet
- ▶ **“Thou has been created with an excellent character”**
- ▶ The Prophet highlighted one of his main objective is to perfecting good morals
- ▶ **“I have been sent for the purpose of perfecting good morals”**



Degrees of Lawful and Unlawful Behavior in Islam



- ▶ In explaining the moral code of Islam, it is important to categorize the action according to the degree of lawfulness and unlawfulness as classified in Fiqh to five categories;
- ▶ Fard , Mustahabb , Mubah , Makruh and Haram



Five Categories



- ▶ **Fard** - It represents the class of actions that is mandatory on every Muslim, such as praying five times a day, fasting the month of Ramadan, paying zakah and performing hajj
- ▶ **Mustahabb** - Describes the class of actions that are not obligatory but highly recommended to do. e.g., fasting beyond the month of Ramadan, put perfume during Friday prayer, or praying nawafil etc.
- ▶ **Mubah** - Actions are permissible in the sense they are specified neither as mandatory nor as forbidden. e.g., trading during hajj



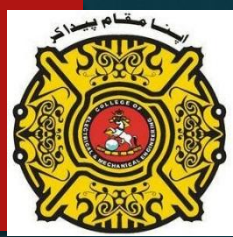
Five Categories



- ▶ **Makruh** - Actions are not absolutely forbidden, but are detested
- ▶ **Haram** - Actions are unlawful and prohibited. Committing them is a major sin. e.g., murder, commit adultery, dealing with riba , drinking alcohol etc.



The Sharia Law System



Category	Arabic	Do it	Not do it
Obligatory (Prescribed)	Fard Wajeb	Reward	Punishment
Recommended (Desirable)	Mustahab	Reward	No Punishment
Permitted (Allowed)	Mubah Halal	No Reward	No Punishment
Discouraged (Disliked)	Makruh	No Punishment	Reward
Forbidden (Prohibited)	Haraam	Punishment	No Reward



Al-Ghazali's Theory of Ethics



- ▶ The Psychological Nature of Man
- ▶ Knowledge and Morality
- ▶ The Freedom of the Will



The Psychological Nature of Man



- ▶ The self is the essence of man, al-Ghazzali divided the self into four:
- ▶ *Qalb* (Heart)
- ▶ *Ruh* (Soul)
- ▶ *Nafs* (Desire-Nature)
- ▶ *Aql* (Intellect, Reason)



The Psychological Nature of Man



- ▶ According to Al-Ghazali all psychological phenomena of man originated in the Self, such as:
- ▶ What is the nature of the Self?
- ▶ What is the ultimate purpose of it?
- ▶ Wherein lie its misery and happiness?



The Psychological Nature of Man



- ▶ According to al-Ghazzali there are six powers included in the Self of man:
- ▶ ***Appetite,***
- ▶ ***Anger,***
- ▶ ***Impulse,***
- ▶ ***Apprehension,***
- ▶ ***Intellect and***
- ▶ ***Will***
- ▶ Appetite, anger, impulse and apprehension are common to man and animals. The self of man possesses two additional qualities which distinguish him from animals, and enable him to attain spiritual perfection which are the 'Aql (intellect) and Irada (will)



Knowledge and Morality



- ▶ According to Al-Ghazali morality and good conduct are not possible without knowledge
- ▶ Knowledge results from the functioning of intellect of reason ('aql) which is the innate rational faculty of man, the faculty which distinguishes him from animals
- ▶ Man occupies a position midway between animals and angels; and his distinguishing quality is knowledge. He can either rise to the level of the angels with the help of knowledge, or fall to the level of animals by letting his anger and lust dominate him
- ▶ It is, therefore, knowledge which helps the growth of the divine element in him and makes possible the realization of the ideal



The Freedom of the Will



- ▶ Al-Ghazali holds the fact that human character can be changed, and improved certainty implies that man possesses some degree of free will
- ▶ The progress that man changes from the state of *an-Nafsal-Ammarah* to the state of *an-Nafsal-Mutma'inna* through ordeals and pains clearly indicate that he is free in his will
- ▶ This freedom is not absolute, yet it is of paramount importance, for it is sufficient to effect the necessary change in human character



Al-Ghazali's Four Classes of Mankind



- ▶ **1st Class** - There are some individuals whose character is yet unformed, who are lacking in the ability to distinguish between good and evil, between right and wrong
- ▶ They are ignorant, lacking in reflection and self-consciousness, possessing no moral character, no will, and no belief
- ▶ They have yet not wholly become slaves to the pleasures of the senses
- ▶ The character of such men can be improved easily. They need only a guide, a determination and a motive to help them follow the right path



Al-Ghazali's Four Classes of Mankind



- ▶ **2nd Class** - Some individuals despite being addicted to the indulgence of the lower appetites are, nevertheless, alive to their evil effects
- ▶ They can discriminate between good and evil. Their consciousness is fully developed and they realize that the rational self is the only true self
- ▶ Yet, they submit to the demands of their lower selves because they are not practiced in subjecting their actions to the power of their will. They have knowledge
- ▶ They can be reformed, firstly by abandoning their habits, and secondly, by cultivating virtuous habits
- ▶ Such men are agreeable to good influence, if they have the will to improve their characters



Al-Ghazali's Four Classes of Mankind



- ▶ **3rd Class** - Some individuals are not only addicted to evil ways but also believe that those ways are good and to follow them is necessary
- ▶ Regarding such people it can be said that the real nature of things has become obscured in their minds; consequently, the gratification of the lower self appears to them as the sole end of human life
- ▶ They have been brought up in ignorance. Their animal self has grown at the expense of their rational self. It has completely suppressed it and rendered it ineffective
- ▶ To reform them is almost impossible



Al-Ghazali's Four Classes of Mankind



- ▶ **4th Class** - There are some who, in having been brought up in the way mentioned in 3rd Class, are proud of doing evil of leading others astray They take pride in doing so
- ▶ The improvement of such men is the hardest of all. Only a conversion through Divine power can bring about a radical change in their case.
- ▶ It is about the third and the fourth types of men that the Holy Quran says (2:7) God has set a seal upon their hearts and upon their hearing, and over their eyes is a covering, and there is a great punishment for them



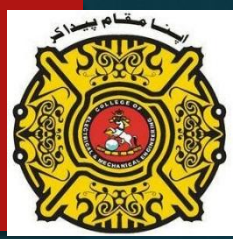
Ethical Theories and Islamic Perspective



Theory	Main Idea	Islamic Perspective
Utilitarian theory	“Ethically right” means the action results in a greater number of utilities than could be achieved by any other actions.	Rejected because the only basis for this theory is the greatest consequences for greatest number.



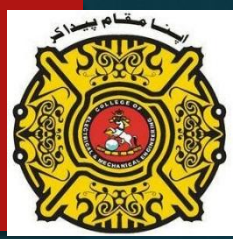
Ethical Theories and Islamic Perspective



Theory	Main Idea	Islamic Perspective
Deontology theory	It underlines the duty as a basis of moral category which can be seen as a right or wrong judgment. It does not look at the consequences of action. And, there are universal ethical actions that everyone must accept.	Rejected because the theory is not clear about the source of these “universal ethics” since in Islam the only source for ethical system is the Islamic principles.



Ethical Theories and Islamic Perspective



Theory	Main Idea	Islamic Perspective
Virtue ethics theory	This theory focuses on what makes a good individual or person rather than what makes a good action. There are specific virtue traits that every person must have such as - civility, - cooperativeness, - courage, fairness, - friendliness, - generosity, honesty, - justice, loyalty, self-confidence, self-control, modesty, - fairness, and - tolerance.	Rejected because the only basis for this theory is virtue ethics.



Ethical Theories and Islamic Perspective



Theory	Main Idea	Islamic Perspective
Divine Command theory	“Ethically right” means “commanded by God”, and “ethically wrong or unethically” means “forbidden by God”. Religion is the only standard to identify ethics.	Accepted, but this theory was rejected in the Western literature.

THANK YOU.....

